

07 External Freight and Inventory Report

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Prepared by Fictional independent industry research desk

SYNTHETIC DEMO. Entirely fictional research and events; no actual industry survey was conducted.

Research scope

Synthetic note by the Fictional Consumer Goods Logistics Desk, dated December 7, 2026. A simulated panel of 40 importers provided comparable quotes for the same route basket between November 2 and November 30. These are fictional observations, not an actual freight index or a change in law.

Observations

The median quoted ocean-freight index rose from 100 to 135 on a constant-route basis. Twenty-six of 40 importers reported delivery estimates at least seven days later. Eleven of those 26 reported enough buffer stock to avoid an immediate sales interruption. Quotes exclude duties, inland distribution and product acquisition costs.

Possible effects and limits

More expensive replenishment can increase inventory cost, cash needs and eventually COGS as goods sell. Buying ahead can preserve availability while consuming liquidity. Unaccepted quotes do not establish invoiced costs, ownership of goods, lost revenue or a specific borrower's exposure. Long-term carrier terms and alternate routes may reduce the effect. No company is named and no product recall, tariff change or covenant breach is asserted.

Evidence required

Review actual shipment invoices, title-transfer terms, cost layers, inventory aging, sales, customer receipts and supplier payment commitments. Separate goods already sold from inventory still held before assessing margin and cash consequences.